

the manufacturing process. The device, including charger, is free from harmful substances such as brominated flame retardants, beryllium and phthalate.

Simple to set the screen brightness, backlight duration and Bluetooth to an energy-efficient mode, the unique user interface allows the user to be energy-efficient with just one click of 'Eco' mode. Through the 'eco walk' function the user can count his steps with an in-built pedometer, calculating how much CO₂ emissions have been reduced by walking as opposed to motor transport. This unique function allows the user to calculate the value of this footprint through the number of trees that have been saved.

The phone comes with a five-star energy-efficient charger which uses standby power of less than 0.03W.

Power meter from Google

Google is developing a tool called PowerMeter that will show people their electricity consumption in near real time on a secure iGoogle gadget. The Internet giant is partnering with a host of electric utilities, device makers, regulators and other technology companies to deliver the data to consumers.

The Google PowerMeter is a piece of software that people can view online to see how much electricity they are using every time they leave an appliance 'on' overnight.

"If 5.3 million people used the new tool and cut back their electricity consumption by 10 per cent, they would save the equivalent of a gigawatt of power—enough to power a large city," said Kirsten Olsen Cahill.

The electricity-monitoring project is also consistent with Google's goal of organising all the world's information, Cahill said. Getting it to work, of course, will require aligning the interests of government, utilities and manufacturers of things like sensors for electricity meters.

World's smallest TV data card

ZTE claims to have developed the world's smallest TV data card and also the world's first plug-and-play data



CSR's 802.11n range of devices add Wi-Fi to mobile devices

card. This USB modem (MF645) will enable you to watch digital television on a computer or laptop over a 3G connection. As the MF645 supports a download rate of up to 7.2Mbps, it offers a user experience that is similar to traditional TV sets.

World's smallest 802.11n devices

Cambridge Silicon Radio (CSR) claims to have launched the world's smallest and lowest-cost range of 802.11n compatible devices to add to its Connectivity Centre line-up. At less than 16 mm² of silicon, the UniFi UF6000 range of Wi-Fi chips are designed as embedded Wi-Fi products, making them a low-cost way of adding an 802.11n-enabled Wi-Fi to mobile devices.

As more smart and feature-phones start to include Wi-Fi, the UniFi UF6000 Wi-Fi range provides manufacturers with a low-cost route to integrate Wi-Fi into handsets without compromising on performance or PCB space.

By combining the UF6000 with the company's recently launched low-cost GPS and Bluetooth chip, BC7830, CSR claims to offer customers Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, GPS and FM transmit and receive at a combined silicon area of 27 mm²—in comparison to competing solutions that are 40 per cent bigger.

The UniFi UF6000 range is fully compliant with IEEE802.11e QoS, Wi-Fi Alliance WMM Power Save and 802.11n power saving, ensuring the lowest possible power consumption.

3D graphics in HDTV devices

The graphical user interfaces offered by today's set-top boxes (STBs) and digital TVs are primarily static and two-dimensional, and generally do not provide the level of performance demanded by the new Web-based interactive services. These services require a new breed of STB and TV user interfaces, based on advanced graphics technologies.

STMicroelectronics offers broadcasters, operators and STB and digital TV manufacturers advanced 3D graphics effects within its latest high-definition video consumer platforms. Based on its latest generation of HD STB processors, including the STi7105, STi7111 and the recently announced STi7141, together with advanced software libraries, these digital consumer TV platforms offer advanced 3D graphic acceleration capabilities for a new generation of user interfaces, enabling 3D dynamic effects, such as transparency, mirroring, rotation and zoom-in and zoom-out; graphical compositions, or animations, combined with live HD